

the support is awesome. The free version of MySQL serves as the foundation for the CMSs discussed above and various other software. You can administer the database using the command-line utility *mysql*, with dozens of commands for effective management. You can integrate it with PHP, Java and other programming languages to make an effective application. You can use MySQL Workbench, which is a GUI tool for integration of database design, administration and maintenance into a single IDE for the MySQL database system.



Figure 4: MySQL

6. Apache Web server

Apache has been the most popular Web server since April 1996 and hosts nearly 60 per cent of Web domains. It has been released under the Apache License and doesn't require modified versions to be distributed under the same licence. Its features are:

- Though developed for UNIX-like OSs, it also runs on Windows, Mac OS X and others.
- Common language interfaces support PHP, Perl, Tcl and Python.
- Virtual hosting allows one Apache installation to serve many different websites.
- Supports password authentication and digital certificate authentication.
- As its source code is available, you can modify it according to your needs, if you know what you are doing.
- Other features include Secure Sockets Layer, Transport Layer Security support, a URL re-writer and custom log files.

7. Apache Tomcat

As stated by its website, Apache Tomcat is an open source software implementation of the Java Servlet and Java Server Pages technologies. Tomcat should not be confused with the Apache server. Tomcat is a Web container that serves Web pages written in Java, while Apache is an HTTP server written in C. It is a collaborative effort of world-class developers from across the globe. I have used it with Eclipse IDE, and I can vouch for the fact that it is pure plug-and-play; no hard-and-fast configuration is needed.

8. Inkscape

Inkscape is a vector-based graphics application, and by far the most popular open source option for a graphics tool if you aim to decorate your website. It has powerful tools

to create graphics from scratch, or to edit. The program supports the standard Scalable Vector Graphics (SVG) file format, as well as many others. It imports files from many formats, including *.jpg*, *.png*, *.tif* and others, and exports to numerous vector-based formats and *.png*. Don't compare it with its proprietary counterparts, as they are more powerful. Among free tools, Inkscape is the best and is being developed further. The final release that I used suffices for a Web developer.

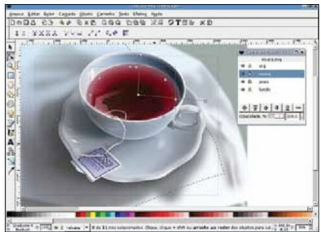


Figure 5: Inkscape

9. FileZilla

FileZilla is a free and open source FTP, FTPS and SFTP client. It is also available as a server if you want to make files available to others, but this works for Windows only. Created in January 2001 by Tim Klose as a class project, FileZilla has gone on to become the fifth most popular download of all time from SourceForge.net. Its most important features are:

- Supports FTP, FTP over SSL/TLS (FTPS) and SSH File Transfer Protocol (SFTP).
- Being cross-platform, it runs on Windows, Linux, *BSD, Mac OS X and more.
- Supports resume and transfer of files larger than 4 GB.

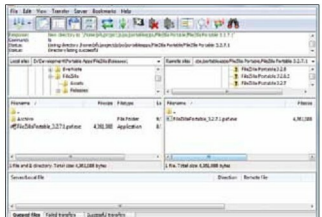


Figure 6: FileZilla